

RECONSTRUCTION

COTE-HARDIE

This carefully constructed replica of a parti-coloured medieval *cote-hardie* (outerdress), with its undergarments, is in blue and murrey (mulberry-red). It follows the styles found on memorial brasses from around 1375–85, which show the wives of knights and barons in formal or courtly dress. The cut and construction – four A-line, floor-length panels of fulled (thickened) wool twill with short set-in sleeves – have been conjectured by dressmaker Sarah Thursfield. Although the shape looks simple to modern eyes, the figure-hugging cut and low neck were considered shocking at the time, and the bright dyes and rows of tiny buttons were condemned as extravagant. Under the dress is a grey wool kirtle, lined with blue linen and laced at the centre front.



SIDE VIEW



SIDE VIEW

TWO FOR ONE ▴ ▾

The mi-parti (part-coloured) effect of this dress was very fashionable. The dress is constructed in identical halves so it appears entirely red from one side and entirely blue from the other.

Sleeves of the grey kirtle (undergarment) visible beneath the shorter sleeves of the *cote-hardie*, but the linen shift is entirely concealed

Narrow cut at the waist gives a smooth, flat outline

Simple A-line shape is created from four panels

Dress widens and becomes fuller towards the hem

Neckline is cut straight across the back

Shaped sleeve head set into a close-fitting armhole is a 14th-century innovation



BACK VIEW